FINN-OLE HÖNER

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PhD supervisors: Bas Donkers ◇ Martijn de Jong

RESEARCH PROFILE

PhD candidate developing generative AI methods for innovation management & market research

Synthetic respondents in marketing · text-generating embeddings · multi-agent systems · GenAI methods for market research

EXPERIENCE

Erasmus School of Economics—*PhD Candidate, Quantitative Marketing* 2024–Present

· Research on synthetic respondents, text-generating embeddings, and multi-agent systems in marketing
· Teaching on Text Analytics and data-science case studies with industry partners

Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam—*Research Assistant* 2022–2023

· Prof. Francesca Sotgiu and Dr. Georgia Liadeli

Deutsche Bundesbank (RIAD Data Lab)—*Data Science Intern* 2021

· Scalable data pipelines for corporate credit datasets
· NLP-based entity resolution and classification

Lidl (Advanced Analytics)—*Data Science Intern* 2020

· ML forecasting of promotions using time-series and text features
· Deployment within retail big-data infrastructure

University of Tübingen—*Research Assistant* 2018–2020

· Prof. Dominik Papies and Prof. Kerstin Pull

EDUCATION

PhD in Quantitative Marketing—*Erasmus School of Economics* Expected 2027

· Thesis: *Generative AI methods for innovation management & market research*

Research Master in Business Data Science; cum laude (8.27)—*Tinbergen Institute* 2024

· Full scholarship (merit-based) (2022/23, 2023/24)
· Machine Learning, Econometrics, Marketing, Business Economics, Operations Research
· Thesis: *Novel Generative Embeddings for Market Research* (8.5—highest thesis grade in cohort)

M.Sc. Data Science in Business and Economics; cum laude (1.24[1])—*University of Tübingen* 2022

· Texas A&M University (semester abroad in M.Sc. Economics; full scholarship)
· Machine Learning (Computer Science; Cyber Valley), Econometrics
· Thesis: *Semi-supervised LDA for Measuring Geopolitical Risk* (1.0)

B.Sc. in Economics & Business Administration; cum laude (1.47)—*University of Tübingen* 2019

· Thesis: *Logistic Regression Analysis of the Hot Hand Phenomenon* (1.0)

Abitur (1.80)—*Karl-von-Frisch Gymnasium Dußlingen* 2016

· Focus areas: Mathematics, Economics, Physics, English, German

[1] German grading scale: 1.0 top grade

WORKING PAPERS

* Höner, F.-O., de Jong, M., & Pieters, R. (2026). Using LLMs to Measure Sensitive Topics: Synthetic Respondents, Real Challenges *Revise & resubmit, International Journal of Research in Marketing.*

* Höner, F.-O., Donkers, B., & Fok, D. (2026). Text-Generating Embeddings for Marketing Text Refinement and Validation. *Targeting submission in November 2026, Journal of Marketing Research.*

Höner, F.-O., Wichmann, J. R. K., van Crombrugge, M., & Stremersch, S. (2026). Agentic Teams for Strategic Ideation. *Targeting submission in January 2027, Journal of Marketing Research.*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Marketing Science Conference—*Washington D.C., USA* 2025

· Special Session: *Using LLMs to Measure Sensitive Topics: Synthetic Respondents, Real Challenges*

Marketing Science Conference—*Lisbon, Portugal* 2026

· Contributed Session: *Text-Generating Embeddings for Marketing Text Refinement and Validation*
· Doctoral Consortium

TEACHING

Erasmus School of Economics—*Teaching Assistant, Supervisor and Instructor* 2024–Present

· Teaching assistant in "Text Analytics" (2025)
· Bachelor's and master's thesis supervision (one winning a national thesis award) (2025)
· Instructor for UNICEF case study (teaching evaluation 4.84/5 ($N = 25$)) (2026, 2027)

Tinbergen Institute—*Teaching Assistant, Workshop Developer and Instructor* 2023–Present

· Teaching assistant in "Principles of Programming for Econometrics" (2023)
· Teaching assistant in "Machine Learning 2" (2024)
· Teaching assistant in "Natural Language Processing" (2024)
· Instructor of skills workshop "Research Idea Generation: AI" (2025, 2026, 2027)
· Instructor of Tinbergen Summer School "AI Agents in Economics and Business Research" (2026, 2027)

University of Tübingen—*Teaching Assistant* 2017–2018

· Teaching assistant in "Introduction to Bookkeeping" (2017, 2018)

GRANTS

2025

· Google Cloud Academic Research Grant — €2,000
· SURF Small Compute Grant — €2,500
· ERIM Support Programme (Travel) — €1,000
· TI Research Support — €2,000

2026

· SURF Small Compute Grant — €2,500
· ERIM Support Programme (Travel) — €750
· ERIM Support Programme (Research) — €4,750

ACADEMIC SERVICE

International Journal of Research in Marketing — newsletter writer

Group Decision and Negotiation — ad-hoc reviewer, special issue: *Artificial Intelligence in Group Decision and Negotiation*

SKILLS

Programming languages	Python & R (excellent); Julia, Stan & MATLAB (good); Node.js, HTML, CSS & Rust (basic)
Tools & frameworks	PyTorch, Transformers, OpenRouter, LangChain, CUDA, SLURM, GitHub, SQL, Pi-agent, DevOps
Languages	German (native), English (fluent), Dutch (B2), Spanish (B2)